

Abstract

Background: Bulimia Nervosa (BN) is an eating disorder, characterized by the cycle of bingeing and purging. The bulimic individual has recurrent episodes of binge eating induced by triggers either emotional or mental, these episodes are mostly followed by compensatory mechanisms to neutralize the effect of bingeing by vomiting or misuse of laxatives, etc. This causes negative repercussions, which is why many therapeutic interventions have been developed to treat this disorder, and hence it is necessary to determine the efficacy, applicability, and affordability of these treatments to identify the efficacy and suitability of each approach. This review aims to discuss the nutritional therapies for bulimia nervosa and assess the efficacy of this intervention.

Method: A thorough search was conducted using four databases; PubMed, Google Scholar, CINAHL, and the University of Chester Library. All relevant literature since the 1980s, written in the English language was collected then narrowed down according to the inclusion and exclusion criteria.

Conclusion: Pure Nutritional therapy or counselling has limited or no efficacy as a stand-alone treatment and compared with a placebo. However, nutritional intervention is highly effective when incorporated with cognitive techniques, Medication, or exercise.

Keywords: Eating disorder, bulimia nervosa, nutritional therapy, nutritional management, the role of nutrition, dietary therapy, nutrition in bulimia.